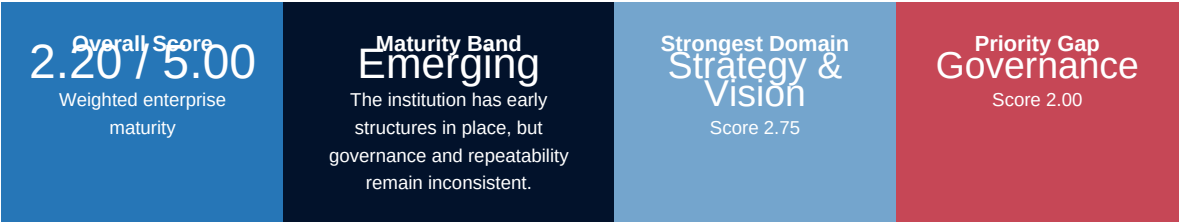


Higher Education CRM Maturity Assessment

Executive report generated 2026-05-14T15:07:29+00:00 · Assessment token 1ebae3d24d4f



Executive Summary

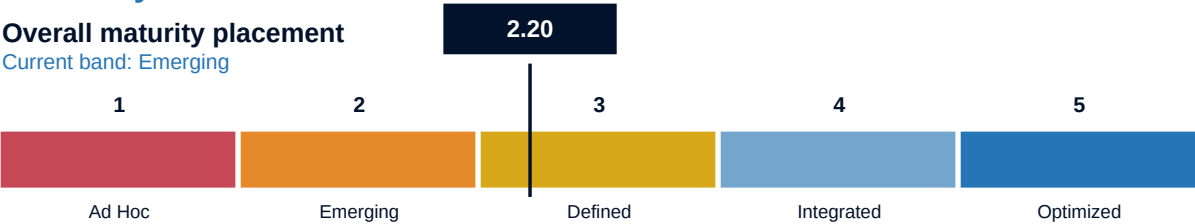
Executive Styling Demo University currently scores 2.20 out of 5.00, which places it in the Emerging maturity band. The assessment suggests the institution's CRM environment is best understood as an institutional coordination challenge rather than simply a platform question. Priority focus areas should center on low-scoring domains, especially where fragmented governance, lifecycle orchestration, data trust, or process inconsistency are limiting measurable outcomes.

The institution has early structures in place, but governance and repeatability remain inconsistent.

Institution	Executive Styling Demo University	Type	Research university
Enrollment	25,001–50,000	Decentralization	Hybrid
CRM landscape	Slate in enrollment, Salesforce in advanced CRM, success modeling, retention, advising coordination, lifecycle orchestration		
	Strategic priorities: Success modeling, retention, advising coordination, lifecycle orchestration		

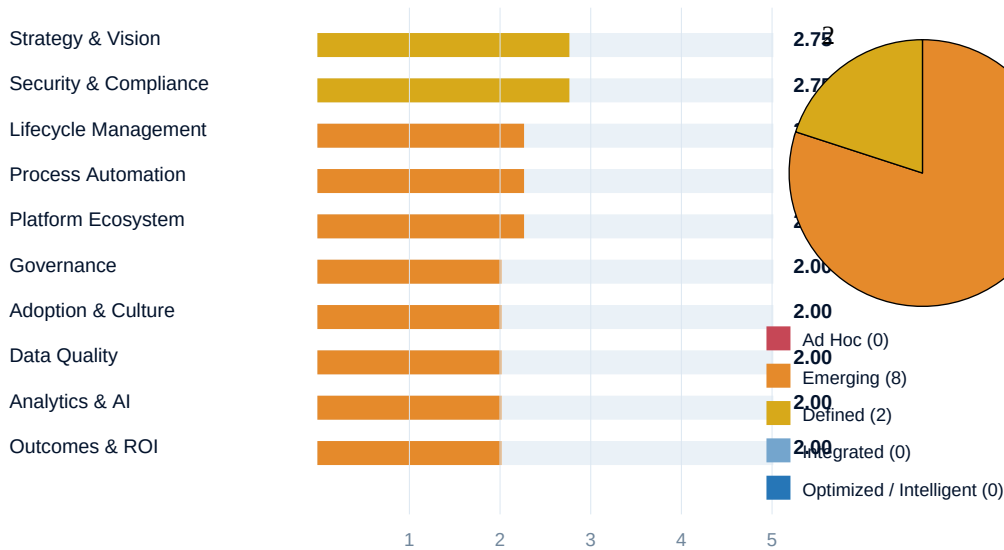
Visual Analytics

Overall maturity placement
Current band: Emerging

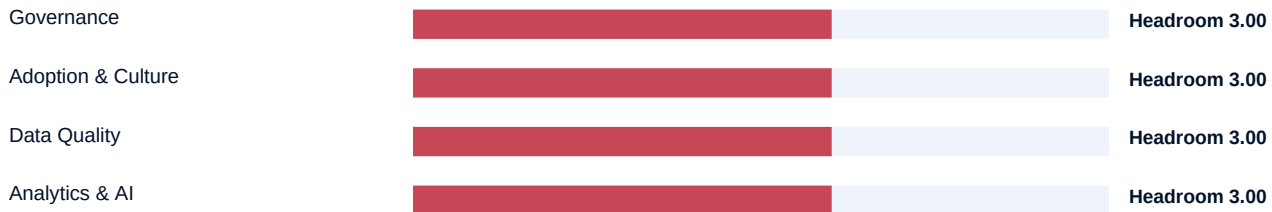


Domain score profile

Higher scores indicate more integrated and enterprise-scale capability.



Improvement headroom across lowest-scoring domains



Domain Scorecard

Domain	Weight	Score	Recommended next move
Governance & Organizational Model	7%	2.00	Stand up an enterprise CRM governance council with clear intake, escalation,
User Adoption & Culture	10%	2.00	Assess training gaps and identify where shadow systems are replacing intend
Data Architecture & Data Quality	15%	2.00	Document the system of record, key data definitions, and highest-risk quality i
Analytics, Reporting & AI Capability	10%	2.00	Define the core CRM KPI set and improve dashboard access for leaders and
Outcomes & Value Realization	8%	2.00	Define outcome measures for enrollment, student success, advancement, and
Student / Constituent Lifecycle Management	15%	2.25	Map high-value journeys for prospect, applicant, student, at-risk, alumni, dono
Process Standardization & Automation	10%	2.25	Document the highest-volume workflows and identify manual bottlenecks, har
Technology & Platform Ecosystem	10%	2.25	Inventory CRM-adjacent platforms and identify the biggest duplication and inte
Institutional CRM Strategy & Vision	8%	2.75	Create a multi-year roadmap with governance checkpoints, funding logic, and
Security, Privacy & Compliance	7%	2.75	Standardize retention and third-party review practices across CRM-connected

Heatmap Prioritization Table

This heatmap uses red, yellow, and green maturity coloring to highlight stabilization priorities, build priorities, and scale opportunities across the CRM capability stack.

Domain	Score	Maturity Signal	Budget	Effort	Recommended Action
Governance	2.00	Needs immediate stabilization	Low	Medium	Stand up an enterprise CRM governance council with clear intake, escalation, and decision processes.
Adoption & Culture	2.00	Needs immediate stabilization	Low	Medium	Assess training gaps and identify where shadow systems are replacing intended CRM workflows.
Data Quality	2.00	Needs immediate stabilization	Medium	Medium–High	Document the system of record, key data definitions, and highest-risk quality issues.
Analytics & AI	2.00	Needs immediate stabilization	Medium	Medium–High	Define the core CRM KPI set and improve dashboard access for leaders and frontline teams.
Outcomes & ROI	2.00	Needs immediate stabilization	Low	Medium	Define outcome measures for enrollment, student success, and retention.
Lifecycle Management	2.25	Needs immediate stabilization	Medium	Medium–High	Map high-value journeys for prospect, applicant, student, and alumni.
Process Automation	2.25	Needs immediate stabilization	Low–Medium	Medium	Document the highest-volume workflows and identify manual tasks for automation.
Platform Ecosystem	2.25	Needs immediate stabilization	Medium	Medium–High	Inventory CRM-adjacent platforms and identify the biggest integration opportunities.
Strategy & Vision	2.75	Build toward integration	Medium	Medium	Create a multi-year roadmap with governance checkpoints and milestones.
Security & Compliance	2.75	Build toward integration	Medium	Medium	Standardize retention and third-party review practices.

Consultant-Facing Recommendations

Governance & Organizational Model

Score 2.00 · High priority

Stand up an enterprise CRM governance council with clear intake, escalation, and decision processes.

- Map current decision rights and identify governance collisions across units.
- Design a governance charter, intake model, and prioritization rubric.
- Establish change sponsorship and cross-functional communication routines.

User Adoption & Culture

Score 2.00 · High priority

Assess training gaps and identify where shadow systems are replacing intended CRM workflows.

- Measure adoption by role and workflow, not just license count.
- Create role-specific enablement paths and leader scorecards.
- Introduce usage governance for shadow spreadsheets and off-platform processes.

Data Architecture & Data Quality

Score 2.00 · High priority

Document the system of record, key data definitions, and highest-risk quality issues.

- Create a constituent data model and profile unification roadmap.
- Prioritize quality issues by business impact and process dependency.
- Define integration patterns and stewardship accountability for critical data objects.

Analytics, Reporting & AI Capability

Score 2.00 · High priority

Define the core CRM KPI set and improve dashboard access for leaders and frontline teams.

- Align KPI definitions to executive and frontline decision points.
- Prioritize analytics use cases by feasibility, value, and data readiness.
- Establish an AI governance and use-case pipeline for CRM-adjacent opportunities.

Client Roadmap — Quick Wins

Near-term actions should reduce operational friction, establish trust, and address the most visible CRM coordination failures.

Budget and effort indicators are directional planning signals intended to support client prioritization conversations rather than replace formal business cases.

Governance · current score 2.00

Quick win objective: Independent departmental systems and political friction drive CRM decisions.

Recommended initiative: Stand up an enterprise CRM governance council with clear intake, escalation, and decision processes.

Consulting support:

- Map current decision rights and identify governance collisions across units.
- Design a governance charter, intake model, and prioritization rubric.
- Establish change sponsorship and cross-functional communication routines.

Budget indicator

Low

Effort indicator

Medium

Adoption & Culture · current score 2.00

Quick win objective: Users avoid CRM, rely on spreadsheets, and see standardization as burden.

Recommended initiative: Assess training gaps and identify where shadow systems are replacing intended CRM workflows.

Consulting support:

- Measure adoption by role and workflow, not just license count.
- Create role-specific enablement paths and leader scorecards.
- Introduce usage governance for shadow spreadsheets and off-platform processes.

Budget indicator

Low

Effort indicator

Medium

Data Quality · current score 2.00

Quick win objective: Manual imports, duplicate records, and spreadsheet reconciliation are common.

Recommended initiative: Document the system of record, key data definitions, and highest-risk quality issues.

Consulting support:

- Create a constituent data model and profile unification roadmap.
- Prioritize quality issues by business impact and process dependency.
- Define integration patterns and stewardship accountability for critical data objects.

Budget indicator

Medium

Effort indicator

Medium–High

Analytics & AI · current score 2.00

Quick win objective: Reporting is mostly retrospective, fragmented, or difficult to access.

Recommended initiative: Define the core CRM KPI set and improve dashboard access for leaders and frontline teams.

Consulting support:

- Align KPI definitions to executive and frontline decision points.
- Prioritize analytics use cases by feasibility, value, and data readiness.
- Establish an AI governance and use-case pipeline for CRM-adjacent opportunities.

Budget indicator

Medium

Effort indicator

Medium–High

Indicator	Meaning
Low	Operating-model, governance, training, or policy work with limited technology spend.
Low–Medium	Targeted workflow changes, enablement, and selective configuration effort.
Medium	Cross-functional process redesign, integrations, or moderate platform investment.
Medium–High	Significant design, integration, data remediation, or multi-team delivery effort.
High	Enterprise-scale transformation, platform modernization, or major data/AI investment.

Client Roadmap — 12-Month Plan

The 12-month horizon should shift the institution from isolated fixes to cross-functional capability building and measurable governance discipline.

Budget and effort indicators are directional planning signals intended to support client prioritization conversations rather than replace formal business cases.

Strategy & Vision · current score 2.75
12-month move objective: CRM is viewed primarily as a departmental tool rather than an institutional capability.
Recommended initiative: Create a multi-year roadmap with governance checkpoints, funding logic, and measurable outcomes.
Consulting support:

- Run a leadership alignment workshop to define target-state CRM outcomes.
- Draft a north-star architecture and roadmap narrative for executive approval.
- Tie roadmap milestones to operating model and KPI ownership.

Budget indicator	Effort indicator
Medium	Medium

Security & Compliance · current score 2.75
12-month move objective: Sensitive data and communication controls are inconsistently managed across platforms.
Recommended initiative: Standardize retention and third-party review practices across CRM-connected systems.
Consulting support:

- Perform a permission and data-handling control review across priority workflows.
- Define a CRM privacy and AI governance checklist for new use cases.
- Add compliance sign-off points to roadmap and release processes.

Budget indicator	Effort indicator
Medium	Medium

Indicator	Meaning
Low	Operating-model, governance, training, or policy work with limited technology spend.
Low–Medium	Targeted workflow changes, enablement, and selective configuration effort.
Medium	Cross-functional process redesign, integrations, or moderate platform investment.
Medium–High	Significant design, integration, data remediation, or multi-team delivery effort.
High	Enterprise-scale transformation, platform modernization, or major data/AI investment.

Client Roadmap — 24-Month Plan

The 24-month horizon should focus on scaling integrated capabilities, analytics maturity, and long-term value realization across the enterprise lifecycle.

Budget and effort indicators are directional planning signals intended to support client prioritization conversations rather than replace formal business cases.

Security & Compliance · current score 2.75
24-month move objective: Sensitive data and communication controls are inconsistently managed across platforms.
Recommended initiative: Expand governance into AI oversight, identity governance, and continuous compliance monitoring.
Consulting support:

- Perform a permission and data-handling control review across priority workflows.
- Define a CRM privacy and AI governance checklist for new use cases.
- Add compliance sign-off points to roadmap and release processes.

Budget indicator Medium	Effort indicator Medium–High
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Strategy & Vision · current score 2.75
24-month move objective: CRM is viewed primarily as a departmental tool rather than an institutional capability.
Recommended initiative: Institutionalize CRM as part of transformation planning and lifecycle-based engagement design.
Consulting support:

- Run a leadership alignment workshop to define target-state CRM outcomes.
- Draft a north-star architecture and roadmap narrative for executive approval.
- Tie roadmap milestones to operating model and KPI ownership.

Budget indicator Medium	Effort indicator Medium–High
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Platform Ecosystem · current score 2.25
24-month move objective: Disconnected platforms and brittle integrations create significant manual effort.
Recommended initiative: Build an event-driven architecture or integration layer that supports low-code orchestration and self-service.
Consulting support:

- Map platform sprawl and identify retire, retain, replace candidates.
- Define target integration patterns and reusable service layers.
- Sequence modernization by constituent impact and technical debt reduction.

Budget indicator High	Effort indicator High
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Indicator	Meaning
Low	Operating-model, governance, training, or policy work with limited technology spend.

Low–Medium	Targeted workflow changes, enablement, and selective configuration effort.
Medium	Cross-functional process redesign, integrations, or moderate platform investment.
Medium–High	Significant design, integration, data remediation, or multi-team delivery effort.
High	Enterprise-scale transformation, platform modernization, or major data/AI investment.